

EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Austin

B.S. Computer Science (Honors) + Neuroscience

incoming · 2026

EXPERIENCE

NVIDIA

2026

Software Engineering Intern — Holoscan

Software engineering on the Holoscan team — NVIDIA's SDK for building real-time, low-latency sensor processing pipelines at the edge, used in domains like medical devices and scientific instruments.

Contrary

2026 –

Research Fellow

Research fellowship with Contrary, studying emerging technology and the companies being built on it — the analytical side of the startup world I otherwise participate in as a builder.

Harvard Medical School × Mass General

2024 – 2026

Researcher

Research on ophthalmic foundation models and AI-guided surgical systems — applying computer vision and representation learning to ophthalmology and the operating room.

Pure Storage

2025 – 2026

Software Engineering Intern

Machine learning on infrastructure telemetry: modeling systems data from storage fleets and predicting EHR workload latency — ML applied to the operational reality of large storage systems.

Memorial Sloan Kettering

2025

Research Intern

Computational cancer research: stage-specific molecular network rewiring and graph representation learning — studying how molecular interaction networks reorganize as cancer progresses.

Xyla Engineering

2025 –

Founder

Founding an engineering company around deployable biofactories for maritime environments — physical systems built to survive the ocean.

Reteena

2024 –

Co-founder

Co-founded an applied AI lab for neurodegenerative diagnostics: Remembrance (AI reminiscence therapy for Alzheimer's patients, with initial patient trials supported by Johns

Hopkins' Pava Center), TRIDENT (adaptive brain-computer interfacing), NeuroLoom, and GeneAttentionNet.

Jdable

2023 – 2026

CTO & Co-founder

Co-founded and led engineering for a grant-funded assistive-technology company — my first experience taking technology from prototype to something real users depend on.

Earlier: Princeton Neuroscience Institute (drosophila connectome mapping & computational neural circuit analysis) · Columbia University (BME) (neural encoding of visual information & working memory dynamics)

PUBLICATIONS

NeuroLoom: A Framework for Reproducible Cortical Microcircuit Modeling with Spiking Neural Networks

ICLR 2026 Workshop on Foundation Models for Science (FM4Science) · 2026 · Workshop paper

Lark: Biologically Inspired Neuroevolution for Multi-Stakeholder LLM Agents

Rikhil Tanugula, Dheeraj Chintapalli, Sunkalp Chandra · *NeurIPS 2025 Workshop on Efficient Reasoning* · 2025 · Workshop paper

GeneAttentionNet: An Attention-Based Architecture for Interpretable Gene Expression Classification on Alzheimer's Disease

Sunkalp Chandra, Gautham Korrapati, Subhadra Vadlamannati · *2025 IEEE MIT Undergraduate Research Technology Conference (URTC)* · 2025 · Conference paper

A Computer Vision and Depth Sensor-Powered Smart Cane for Real-Time Obstacle Detection and Navigation Assistance for the Visually Impaired

Sunkalp Chandra, Umang Sharma, Devesh Khilnani · *2025 IEEE MIT Undergraduate Research Technology Conference (URTC)* · 2025 · Conference paper

Enhanced Predictive Modeling for Hazardous Near-Earth Object Detection: A Comparative Analysis of Advanced Resampling Strategies and Machine Learning Algorithms in Planetary Risk Assessment

Sunkalp Chandra · *arXiv preprint* · 2025 · Preprint

SELECTED PROJECTS

TRIDENT [ACTIVE RESEARCH](#)

2026 –

A personalized neural decoding platform. Large reasoning systems interpret EEG and fMRI with temporal context, then get distilled into lightweight decoders that adapt to the individual brain in real time.

Neural Foundation Models [ACTIVE RESEARCH](#)

2025 –

Research into the latent representations of fMRI foundation models — how they organize neural activity across subjects, contexts, and time — plus TRIBE Explorer, a visual analytics tool for seeing that structure directly.

NeuroLoom [ICLR 2026](#) [FM4SCIENCE WORKSHOP](#)

2025 – 2026

A framework for constructing, simulating, and validating spiking cortical microcircuit models against in-vivo electrophysiology from the Allen Brain Observatory. Workshop paper at ICLR 2026 FM4Science.

Reteena / Remembrance [INITIAL PATIENT TRIALS](#)

2024 –

Reteena is an applied AI lab for neurodegenerative diagnostics that I co-founded. Its flagship, Remembrance, is an AI reminiscence-therapy companion for Alzheimer's patients built on knowledge graphs and LLMs — with initial patient trials supported by Johns Hopkins' Pava Center.

NeuroForge [LIVE](#)

2026

A browser-native CAD tool for neural circuits with real-time simulation — five membrane models, real synaptic kinetics, GPU-accelerated rendering, procedural neuron glyphs. Runs entirely in the browser.

AWARDS

3× AIME qualifier (American Invitational Mathematics Examination)

USACO Gold Division

3× Technology Student Association nationals qualifier

PROGRAMS

Contrary · FR8 Cohort 1.0 · f.inc (off-season) · The Residency

TECHNICAL

Python · PyTorch · TypeScript · React / Next.js · C++ · Java · Brian2 · AllenSDK · signal processing (EEG/fMRI) · graph representation learning · computer vision